How long an outburst lasts helps forecast when the next one begins

SS Cygni and a century of amateur observations

① THE STAR

Outbursts about every seven weeks

Illustrative cycles from 1960 nightly data

② THE TEST

Two forecasters

recent quiet spells

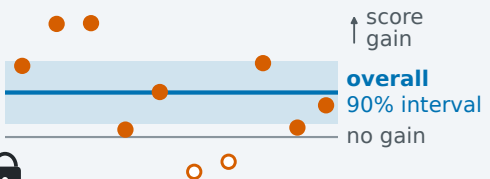
recent quiet spells + outburst length

Frozen and published in 2026, before the test records were opened

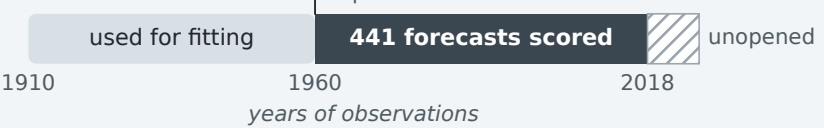
③ THE ANSWER

Better overall, and in 8 of 10 periods

Small gain; 90% interval above zero, meeting the pre-set criterion



Six-year periods (last: four years); open dots: worse



Other stars None of ten other dwarf novae passed the pre-set early-record checks.